

impression on Trevor; he still talks about it. On one hand, he saw money growing; on the other, he saw the potential dangers of losing it all. He also saw that I worked for a living.

By taking your child to work, you have the opportunity to have an enduring impact on his or her perceptions of what it's like to have a job. It should be stimulating and fun, though not *too* fun—it's supposed to be a job, not a day at the theme park. By the time it's over, your child should have a better understanding that this is what you do every day to earn money, and if you didn't, there wouldn't be food in the fridge or birthday cake on the table.

Age 9

Money Games

Assuming your child lives on planet earth, she's going to be hip to computers by age nine, possibly hipper than you! Use this to your advantage. There are all sorts of games and software designed to teach kids financial literacy. I should know—I made a fortune selling children's educational software in the 1990s. Millions of kids around the world learned simple math with Math Rabbit, one of SoftKey's best-selling products. Today there are dozens of computer games where kids have to work toward certain goals; often their avatars must complete specific tasks to earn money and rewards. This kind of role play can be extremely helpful in teaching your child how to set goals and meet them. And, of course, if you're technology-averse, there's always Monopoly. It's a great game; it encourages an understanding of money, property ownership and banking. Oh, and going bankrupt or to jail—two outcomes even the youngest children playing come to understand as negatives.

All of this role-playing around finances should help your child learn to *strategize*.